



In order to achieve its goals, BEE is committed to provide policy framework and direction to national energy conservation and efficiency efforts and programs. It also coordinates energy efficiency and conservation policies and programs and take them to the stakeholders.

Some of the key programs of the Bureau include, Energy Efficiency in Buildings. A important area where with adequate awareness and appropriate guidelines, tremendous savings can be affected.

Another significant area that merits attention of the Bureau is the Standards and Labelling (S&L) Programme that rates the product on a comparative scale. It is the most cost effective programme implemented all over the world. The S&L Programme in USA has resulted in avoided capacity of over 10, 000 MW. Over 35 countries have implemented such programmes. The S&L programme when in place would ensure that only energy efficient equipment and appliances would be made available to consumers.

Standards and Labeling Programme

The Energy Efficiency Standards and Labeling programme is a key thrust Area of BEE. Central Government, under the Energy Conservation Act, 2001 has powers to:

- Direct display of labels on specified appliances or equipment
- Enforce minimum efficiency standards by prohibiting manufacture, sale, and import of products not meeting the minimum standards

The objectives of this program is to provide the consumer an informed choice about the energy saving, and thereby the cost saving potential of the marketed household and other equipment. Along-with the fact that this would impact the energy savings in the medium and long run, it will also position domestic industry to compete in such markets where norms for energy efficiency are mandatory. The Minister of Power, Government of India announced the Standards & Labeling programme on 18th May 2006 initially on a voluntary basis. The programme will be made mandatory after the voluntary phase. Frost Free (No-Frost), Direct cool Refrigerators, Air conditioners and Tubular Florescent Lamps are currently a part of the voluntary scheme. Other products like General Electric Motors, Distribution Transformers, Submersible pump sets and Ceiling Fans will be introduced in a phased manner.

Energy-Efficiency Standards And Labels Standards

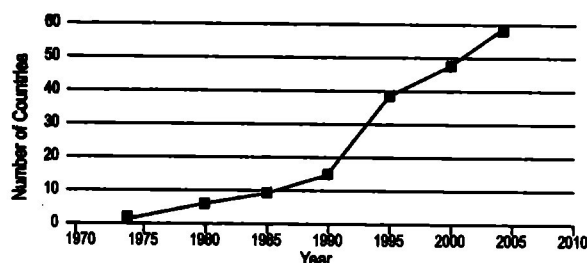
Energy-efficiency standards are procedures and regulations that prescribe the energy performance of manufactured products, sometimes prohibiting the sale of products that are less energy efficient than the minimum standard, often called Minimum Energy Performance Standards (MEPS). MEPS prescribe minimum efficiencies (or maximum energy consumption) that manufacturers must achieve in each and every product, specifying the energy performance.

Informative labels in form of Energy-efficiency labels are then affixed to manufactured products to describe the product's energy performance (usually in the form of energy

use, efficiency, or energy cost); these labels give consumers the data necessary to make informed purchases.

Standards And Labeling Programme

The programme has been used as an effective tool by many countries worldwide to achieve desired results. There has been a steady growth in the number of countries adopting this programme as is indicated in the graph:



(Source: CLASP-ENERGY-EFFICIENCY LABELS AND STANDARDS)

Under the Standards & Labeling Program, appliances are rated on a scale of 1 to 5 stars, with the most efficient carrying a 5 star label and the least efficient carrying a 1 star label. The program has been developed in a collaborative and consensus driven approach with active participation from all the stakeholders. A self-

Ensuring Credibility of Standards and Labeling Programme

- The program will be managed by the Bureau under the guidance of an Implementation Committee.
- Manufacturers test their equipment and self declare the rating level.
- Manufacturers have to print and affix labels as per the label design, manner of display, and the rating plan prescribed for the particular equipment.
- Manufacturers are responsible for accuracy of the information displayed on the label or any public claim for label level and quality of equipment.
- BEE will conduct verification tests on a regular basis to verify the accuracy of labels.
- The label can be challenged by other manufacturers, consumer associations, etc.
- If the equipment is incorrectly labeled, and manufacturers do not rectify the errors as directed, then BEE will inform the consumers through wide publicity.

BEE will conduct the check testing in accredited independent laboratories to maintain the credibility of the program and ensure consumer confidence.